

but a Web Master (see what we did there, eh?), that would be his advice when it comes to inexperienced webmasters getting swayed by the spell of “unlimited” hosting space. What this means is that you should never (and we mean never ever) host multiple websites on the same web server, as it’s a virtual kiss of death when it comes to protecting anyone or all of the multiple websites in question.

Let’s just say it’s easier to manage an infected host server when there’s only one website hosted on it. If there are multiple websites, based on different content management systems, all hosted on the same server, you’re basically leaving the door wide open for intruders to come in and wreak havoc on your web server. There are multiple fail points, in this case, where there are multiple websites hosted on the same server, and anyone being compromised ensures the infection spreads to other CMS installed and hosted in the same space. This is a webmaster’s worst nightmare, and should be avoided at all cost.

The worst part of hosting multiple websites on the same server comes when you’re left to deal with changing every single password associated with every single account that has access to the web server. This includes the CMS installation, MySQL (or any other) database, [FTP](#), and more. If you managed to painstakingly get rid off the infection on your server but didn’t spend time changing all the passwords, it’s a job half done and you’ve left another gaping hole in your websites’ defence waiting to be exploited in due time. Duh!

Deny file permissions

Simply put, file permissions on a web server decide what an entity can do to a certain file hosted online. And no, we aren’t talking about preventing image files being hotlinked here! This is way more important than that, so pay close attention.

In web server terminology, each file hosted online has three levels of permissions attached to it. Read (4), Write (2), Execute (1). The first permission allows for anyone to merely read the file contents, the second permission allows anyone to edit the file contents, and the third and final permission allows anyone to effectively run the program file on the server.

The types of users, who have access to these three types of file permissions, are also divided into three. Owner, Group, Public. An Owner is someone who creates the file for which a permission needs to be set – the values are given by default. Group is a cluster of users with common or